

TASK 1

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Introduction

In today's world, we do many things online, like banking, shopping, and talking to friends. Because we share so much personal information on the internet, it is very important to protect it..

1. Strong Passwords

A strong password is like a good lock on your front door. It makes it very hard for a thief to get in. A password is considered "strong" when it is difficult for both humans and computers to guess. A powerful computer can try millions of guesses per second, so a simple password can be cracked in seconds.

To create a strong password, follow these rules:

- **Length:** Make your password long. It should be at least 12 to 15 characters. The longer it is, the harder it is to crack.
- **Complexity:** Use a mix of different character types. Include uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and special symbols (like @, #, \$, %).
- **Avoid Personal Information:** Never use your name, birthday, or pet's name. This information is easy for hackers to find on your social media.
- **No Dictionary Words:** Do not use common words like "password" or "computer". Hackers use programs that try every word in the dictionary.
- **Unique Passwords:** Use a different password for every single account. If you use the same one for everything, a hacker who breaks into one account can access all your others.

2. Phishing Awareness

Phishing is a type of cyberattack where a criminal pretends to be a legitimate company or a person you trust. The goal is to trick you into giving away sensitive data like passwords, credit card numbers, or bank details.

How a typical phishing attack works:

First, the attacker sends a message to a large number of people. This message is designed to create a sense of urgency or fear. For example, it might say your account has been hacked or you have won a prize. The message contains a link. If you click the link, you are taken to a fake website that looks real. If you enter your information on this fake site, the hackers steal it immediately. They can then use this data to steal money or your identity.

3. Real-Life Examples

People face phishing attacks in many common situations:

- **Email Scams:** This is the most common method. You might receive an email that looks like it is from your bank. It claims there is a problem with your account and asks you to click a link to "verify" your details. The email may look official, with the bank's logo, but the link leads to a dangerous fake page.

- **Fake Login Pages:** This is often used with the email scam. The link you click leads to a website that looks exactly like Facebook or Gmail. When you type your username and password to log in, the fake page records your keystrokes and sends the details to the attacker.
- **Social Media Messages:** Hackers often take over social media accounts and send messages to all the user's friends. You might get a direct message from a friend saying, "I can't believe this video of you! Click here to see it." If you click the suspicious link, it might download a virus onto your device.

4. Protection Methods

You can protect yourself from these attacks by following these methods:

- **Check the Sender:** Always look at the email address, not just the display name. If the email claims to be from PayPal but the address is "paypal.services123@gmail.com", it is a fake. Be suspicious of urgent demands for personal information.
- **Don't Click on Suspicious Links:** Before clicking a link, hover your mouse over it (on a computer) to see the real web address. If the address is long, strange, or does not match the official website, do not click it. It is better to type the company's web address into your browser yourself.
- **Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA):** This is a great security tool. Even if a hacker steals your password, 2FA will stop them. It requires a second code, usually sent to your phone via text or an authenticator app, to log in.
- **Use a Password Manager:** It is hard to remember many complex passwords. A password manager is a safe app that stores all your passwords for you. It can also create strong, random passwords for your accounts.

Conclusion

By creating strong passwords, being cautious about the messages you receive, and using the right protection tools, you can significantly reduce the risk of being hacked.